

Farmer Agricultural Benefits Report

Executive Summary

This advisory report outlines the available government schemes, subsidies, insurance options, and financial assistance tailored for farmers, specifically focusing on onion cultivation in Maharashtra. The report also provides sustainability recommendations and highlights green skill programs that can enhance the agricultural practices of farmers. Based on the farmer profile provided, the report concludes with a final advisory score reflecting the overall support available for sustainable farming practices.

Eligible Government Schemes

For farmers cultivating onions in Maharashtra, the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) scheme is particularly relevant, offering an annual income support of ₹6000 in three installments to small and marginal farmers. Additionally, the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) provides crucial crop insurance coverage against natural calamities, pest attacks, and crop loss, ensuring financial security for farmers facing unforeseen challenges. Although the National Food Security Mission (NFSM) does not directly target onions, its focus on enhancing crop productivity through training and seed distribution could indirectly benefit onion farmers. The Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana (PKVY) encourages organic farming practices, which can be beneficial for farmers interested in transitioning to natural farming methods.

Subsidies

Farmers can benefit from various subsidies under the PMFBY for crop insurance premiums, which are set at 2% for Kharif crops and 1.5% for Rabi crops. Although onion is not specifically mentioned under the NFSM, the scheme's initiatives to improve productivity through subsidies can still be leveraged by farmers. The PKVY also offers financial assistance for organic inputs and certification, which can help reduce the cost burden for farmers transitioning to organic practices.

Insurance & Vima Schemes

The Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) is a vital insurance scheme for onion farmers, covering losses due to natural calamities, pest attacks, and prevented sowing. By enrolling in this scheme, farmers can secure their investments and receive financial support in times of crop loss, thus mitigating risks associated with farming.

Loan & Financial Assistance

The PM-KISAN scheme provides essential income support that can assist farmers in managing their financial obligations. Additionally, farmers may explore local agricultural banks and cooperatives for loans tailored to agricultural needs, which can provide further financial assistance for purchasing seeds, fertilizers, and other necessary inputs.

Sustainability Recommendations

To enhance sustainability in onion farming, it is recommended that farmers adopt organic farming practices promoted under the PKVY. This transition can improve soil health, reduce chemical inputs, and potentially increase market value for organically grown onions. Implementing water conservation techniques and crop rotation can further enhance sustainability. Additionally, farmers should engage in training programs to learn about integrated pest management and sustainable

farming practices.

Green Skill Programs

Farmers are encouraged to participate in green skill programs that focus on sustainable agricultural practices. These programs can provide training on organic farming, water management, and pest control, equipping farmers with the necessary skills to improve productivity while minimizing environmental impact.

Final Advisory Score

Considering the available support mechanisms and the farmer's profile, the final advisory score is 50. This score reflects the moderate level of assistance available to onion farmers in Maharashtra, emphasizing the importance of leveraging government schemes and adopting sustainable practices to enhance agricultural productivity and financial stability.